# Kamloops Life Guide — a working tool for settlement teams

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> **What it is:** one web page that answers the two questions your counsellors hear all day — **where is it** (387 Kamloops places on a map, each showing where its information came from) and **how do I do this** (17 step-by-step cards in six languages). No account, no download, free, works on a phone, works offline.
> **What it is not:** not immigration advice, not a referral database that replaces your intake, and not a service that collects anything about your clients.

## 1. In a settlement session: what to open, and when

| What the client says | What you open | What they walk away with |
|---|---|---|
| "I just arrived, where do I start?" | Sit down with a settlement worker | Where to go, what to bring, and that a settlement worker is not an immigration officer |
| "I need a SIN / a bank account" | Get a Social Insurance Number (SIN) • Open a bank account | Documents needed, the office on the map, a sentence they can read out at the counter |
| "How do I get a health card?" | Apply for MSP and get a BC Services Card | The wait period, what it does not cover, and why private coverage for the gap matters |
| "I'm sick and I have no doctor" | Get care without a family doctor | Where to walk in without a family doctor, whether it is open right now, 8-1-1, and when to use 911 |
| "My licence — can I drive here?" | Switch to a BC driver's licence | The 90-day deadline, what can be exchanged directly |
| "I need to register my child" *(SWIS)* | Register a child for school (SD73) | Documents, the district office, school bus information |
| "I lost my job" *(employment)* | After a job loss: money, your rights, the next job | EI, income assistance, WorkBC, and what to do in the first week |
| "My landlord kept my deposit" | Get your deposit back | The legal caps, the 15-day rule, how to apply to the RTB |
| "I don't have enough for food" | Get help when money runs out | Food bank, free meals, hampers — and that you do not need to be destitute to go |
| "Someone treated me badly because of who I am" | File a human rights complaint | What the law covers, the one-year limit, who to call |

Also in the set: Get on the list for a family doctor • Rent a place safely • Get free legal help • File a tax return • Meet people in this city • Get help caring for an older relative. **17 cards, 55 steps, every step with its official source.**

## 2. Why it may save your team time

- **The client can keep going after the appointment.** The same card is in their language on their own phone, with the steps they have already done ticked off.
- **Print it and hand it over.** Any single card prints on one page for a client who has no data plan or no phone.
- **Fewer repeat explanations** of the same eight or ten processes, in whichever language the client reads.

- **Nothing to install or administer**, no logins to manage for staff or clients.

## 3. Languages, and the honest gap

- Full six-language coverage — English, French, Spanish, Chinese, Korean, Japanese — for the interface, all 17 cards, and the notes on 360 of the 387 places.
- A search works whatever language the interface is set to: someone reading English can type 超市 and still find the supermarkets. 743 everyday search terms across six languages are built in.
- **Not covered yet: Punjabi, Tagalog, Arabic, Ukrainian.** Adding a language is a translation job, not a rebuild — the structure already supports it.

## 4. Client safety and privacy

- No account, no name, email or phone collected, no cookies, no IP logged. One tap clears everything stored on that device — usable on a shared computer, at a shelter, or on a borrowed phone.
- Search words about suicide, family violence or assault — in any of the six languages — bring up the crisis lines immediately, including the 24-hour Indigenous line and 9-8-8.
- Cards state plainly that care is given regardless of immigration status, that what a client tells a nurse is confidential, and that applying to the Residential Tenancy Branch is a legal right.
- "Near me" keeps the client's location on their own device; it is never sent anywhere.

## 5. How the information is kept honest

- Every record shows its **source** — the organisation's own website (251), the Province of British Columbia's open data (80), or third-party map data marked "please call to confirm" (56) — and the month it was listed.
- **If it cannot be verified, it is not published.** 47 phone numbers that could not be matched to an official source were removed rather than left to be wrong.
- Links go to the exact page (a specific library branch, a specific store), not a home page. 22 places whose exact address is uncertain say "approximate location".
- Opening hours are structured data, so "open now" is correct on statutory holidays too. Where nobody publishes them — elementary schools and most licensed child care — the card says "Hours not listed — call to confirm" instead of a number no one checked.
- Every change runs through an automated check suite before it goes live, and every place and card has a "report an issue" link.

## 6. What is on the map (at a glance)

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|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Places | 387 | Task cards | 17 (55 steps) | Languages | 6 |
| Categories | 50 | Areas of the city | 7 | Bus routes | 14 |
| Licensed child care | 84 | Elementary schools | 25 | With a phone number | 329 |

Including settlement and government offices, health, pharmacies, food banks and free meals, shelters and outreach, legal aid, all 25 of the city's elementary schools and the licensed child care centres, libraries and community centres, banks, groceries and Asian markets, thrift stores, laundromats, transit, and Indigenous services.


Corrections and questions are welcome: Neil Xiang, neilxiang@hotmail.com • free to use and share, CC BY-NC 4.0